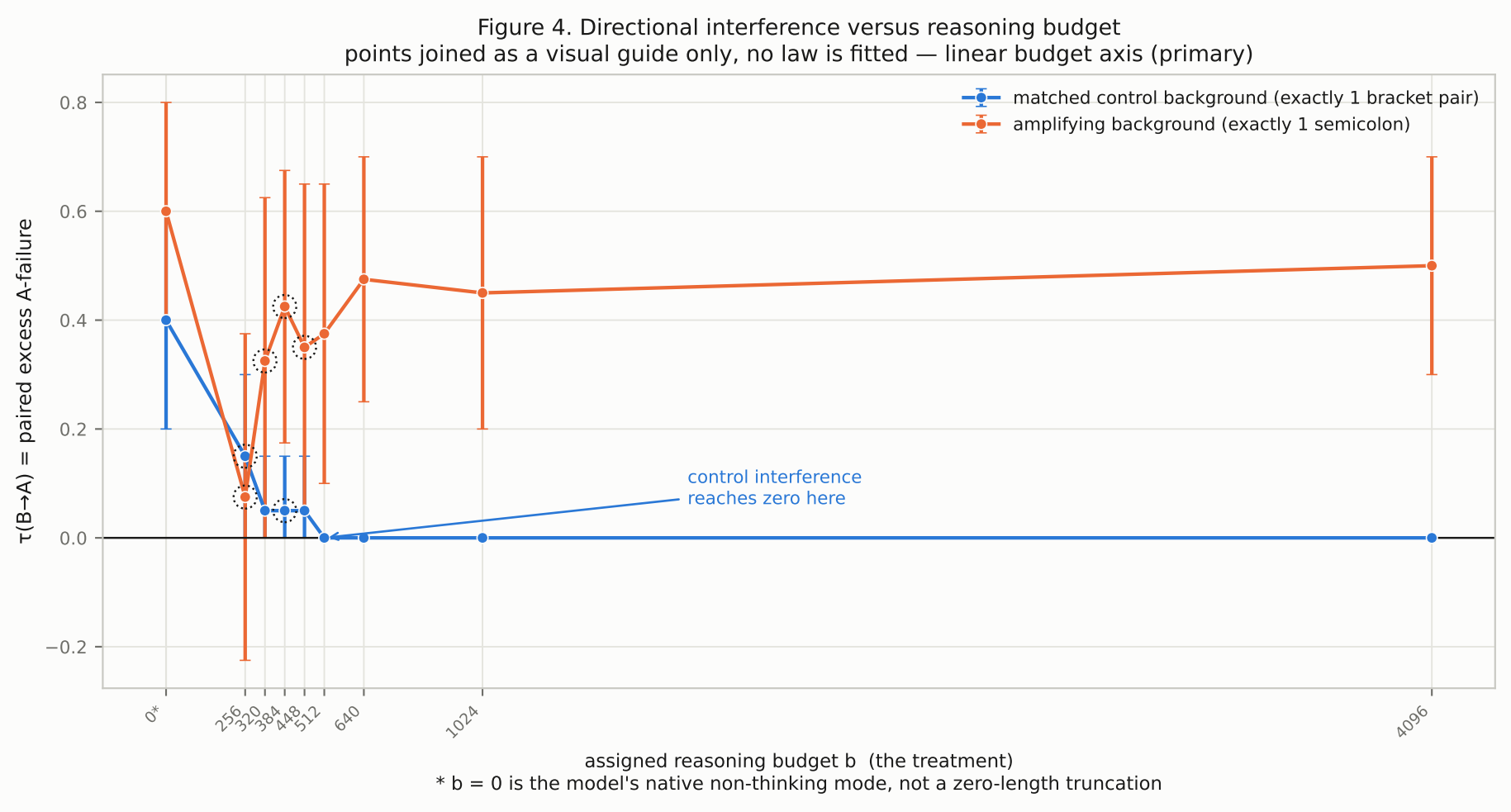
Figure 4. Directional interference versus reasoning budget
points joined as a visual guide only, no law is fitted — linear budget axis (primary)
matched control background (exactly 1 bracket pair)
amplifying background (exactly 1 semicolon)
τ(B→A) = paired excess A-failure
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0
−0.2
control interference
reaches zero here
0*
256
320
384
448
512
640
1024
4096
assigned reasoning budget b (the treatment)
* b = 0 is the model's native non-thinking mode, not a zero-length truncation